INDUSTRIETAG REMS-MURR 2026 | Praxisforum 2026

Recap

AI in planning, construction and building operations

Tuesday, 10 November 2026
Bürgerhaus Kernen-Rommelshausen, 71394 Kernen im Remstal

SCHETTER
Technische Lösungen für Gebäude

GAMECHANGERZ

The day at a glance

A look back at the Praxisforum on 10 November 2026: three keynotes, 16 practice talks in two parallel specialist forums and a trade exhibition with more than 400 guests from planning, construction, building services and operations.

Programme	Exhibition	Hosts
13:00–18:30	**11:00–22:00**	**Wilhelm Schetter GmbH Haustechnik with Gamechangerz**

13:00	**Opening & welcome** Benedikt Paulowitsch, Gemeinde Kernen im Remstal; Heino Wolkenhauer, Wilhelm Schetter GmbH Haustechnik	
13:15	**Keynote 1: State of AI – how will agentic AI change the way we work?** Dr. Andreas Liebl, appliedAI Initiative GmbH	
13:45	**Keynote 2: From AI hype to everyday work: how people and companies start taking action** Michael Aechtler, Gamechangerz UG	
14:15	**Keynote 3: From data to performance: how companies reach higher performance with AI** Hanna Huber, Drees & Sommer SE	
15:00	*Changeover to the two specialist forums – break and networking*	
15:30	Forum 1 **From data to decisions: BIM, automation and AI as accelerators** Patrizia Bengel, ATP architekten ingenieure	Forum 2 **From BIM model to automated job site – how digital planning enables productivity, prefabrication and robotics** Axel Mühlenbruch, Hilti Deutschland AG
15:50	Forum 1 **The data foundation for orchestration – how structured component and zone data make AI-driven procurement and delivery on site possible** Sven Assmann, Adolf Würth GmbH & Co. KG; Matthäus Grzondziel, Adolf Würth GmbH & Co. KG	Forum 2 **AI in the fan: detect conditions, prevent failures, secure operations** André Müller, ZIEHL-ABEGG SE
16:10	Forum 1 **Construction projects that think ahead** Maria Tsagkalidi, alago	Forum 2 **From sensor to decision: how high-quality room and energy data enable intelligent buildings** Philipp Becker, BELIMO; Alexander Saumer, BELIMO
16:30	Forum 1 **When the BIM model costs more than the installation: how AI rescues engineering design** Armin Jäger, EFG Engineering Facility Group	Forum 2 **AI in ventilation technology: practical experience at TROX** Dorothea Völkerling, TROX SE

16:50	Forum 1 **From the hybrid engineering office to agentic work – how five AI agents are changing everyday planning** Christopher Duftschmid, IDZ – Ingenieure der Zukunft	Forum 2 **Creating energy flexibility: how the modular refurbishment of a care home combines efficiency, security of supply and decarbonisation** Johannes Rauh, Bosch Energy and Building Solutions GmbH
17:10	Forum 1 **Data sovereignty instead of a black box: AI in tendering** Liza Ocklenburg, Cosuno Ventures GmbH	Forum 2 **From energy data to measurable savings: the Brugger Magnetsysteme case** Miriam Helbig, Mondas GmbH
17:30	Forum 1 **Building cheaper, faster, better and with fewer resources: how the AI-based OPTIMUSE platform gets more return out of every project** Nomi Aghasi, OPTIMUSE GmbH	Forum 2 **Secure and redundant automation with the QronoX controller** Jürgen Ferstl, SBC Deutschland GmbH
17:50	Forum 1 **Deciding before the data exists: AI in the early planning phase** Dr.-Ing. Bernd Petraus, TMM Group	Forum 2 **Human-centric autonomous buildings: with AI from reactive to predictive building operation** Simon Pfau, Siemens AG – Smart Infrastructure
18:10	**Closing: from impulse to implementation – the next steps** Michael Aechtler, Gamechangerz UG; Heino Wolkenhauer, Wilhelm Schetter GmbH Haustechnik	

What stays with us

The ideas that came up again and again across the talks.

Processes before tools

AI has an effect in planning, construction and operations primarily when processes, data and organisation are changed along with it – not when new tools are simply dropped into old workflows.

Agents prepare, people decide

Agents can prepare routine work (reports, bills of quantities drafts, notes, appointments); approval, assessment and responsibility remain with the specialists.

No AI without good data

Without structured, end-to-end data (components, zones, times, sensor data, ERP), orchestration and predictive operations remain ineffective – “Garbage in, Garbage out”.

Early planning has the biggest leverage

In early-stage planning, AI is particularly useful because the data is poor while the leverage of decisions is high; precision and traceability must be managed deliberately.

Measure and automate first

On the construction site and in existing buildings, automation, measurement quality and transparency often come first (drilling from the model, fan condition, room and energy data, LED and refurbishment measures) – AI comes as the next step.

Security belongs in the design

Cybersecurity and redundancy belong in the planning of building automation, not as an afterthought (example: secure controllers according to IEC 62443).

Leadership and culture matter

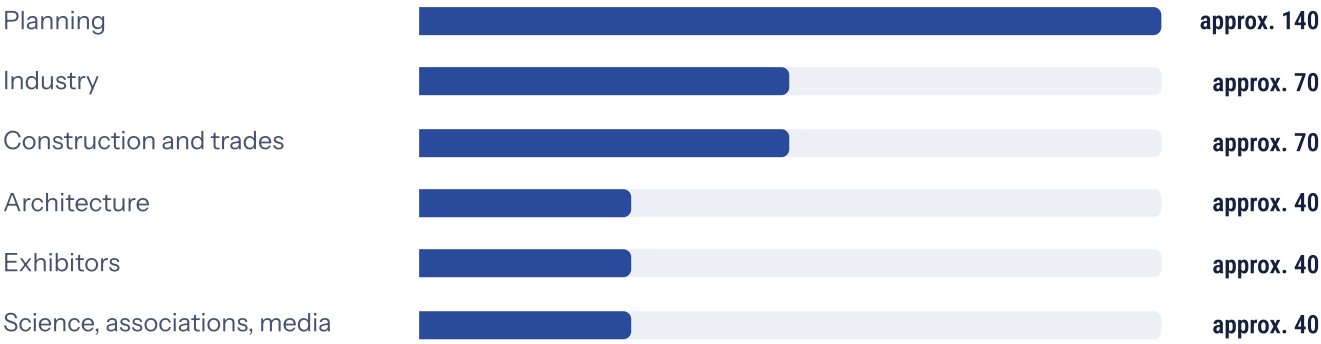
Leadership and culture also decide: spaces to experiment, skills development, and the question of what saved time is used for.

The conversation continues

Participants were told that transcripts and a way to ask questions would be made available in the days after the event.

Who came

The Praxisforum was fully booked. This is how the audience was made up.



Around 400 guests from more than 270 companies, as announced in the welcome.

Numbers from the talks

26 of 50

targeted emails from a first agent campaign led to a meeting

Gamechangerz

−50%

lighting electricity after the LED retrofit at Brugger Magnetsysteme

Mondas

65%

of a care facility's heat demand is covered by heat pumps in the first refurbishment step

Bosch

−15%

total energy costs on average when generation, storage and consumption are controlled predictively

Siemens

Main programme

Saal 1

13:00–13:15

Opening & welcome

Benedikt Paulowitsch, Mayor, Gemeinde Kernen im Remstal; **Heino Wolkenhauer**, Managing Director, Wilhelm Schetter GmbH Haustechnik

- Host Heino Wolkenhauer said Schetter has been working intensively with AI for exactly one year: getting started was hard, but today AI delivers noticeable efficiency gains – initial worry turned into enthusiasm.
- Rather than keep these experiences in-house, the company wanted to share them: the day's partners are companies Schetter has worked with along the way.
- Around 400 guests from more than 270 companies had registered – including about 140 from planning, 70 each from industry and from construction and trades, and 40 architects.
- Mayor Benedikt Paulowitsch praised the entrepreneurial courage and presented Kernen as a nationwide AI pioneer among municipalities: AI agents, AI-generated council minutes and process automation (RPA) are everyday practice at the town hall.
- His key message: first get organisation, culture and mindset ready, then AI delivers its value – simply buying tools is not enough.

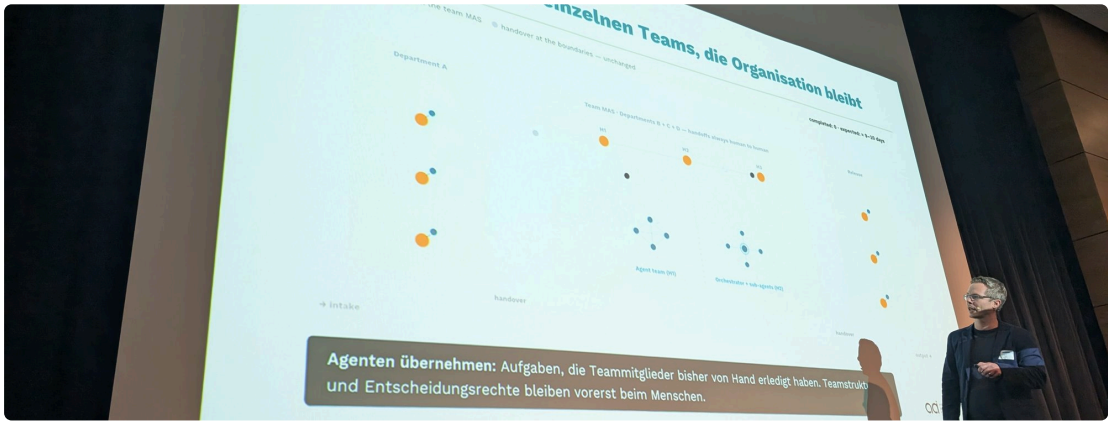
Speaker on stage in front of the slide “Zukunft! Wir sind bereit”

13:15–13:45

Keynote 1: State of AI – how will agentic AI change the way we work?

Dr. Andreas Liebl, Managing Director, appliedAI Initiative GmbH

- Liebl, who co-founded appliedAI almost ten years ago, traced the path from specialised machine learning through generative AI to agents that use tools, plan and delegate subtasks to other agents.
- Tools alone change little: only when processes are redesigned end to end does lead time really fall – the more broadly workflows are questioned, the bigger the effect.
- As a live example he showed a multi-agent system for tenders: agents analyse the request, communicate with suppliers and compare offers; a human tender manager gives the final approval.
- At the next maturity level, agents increasingly take over coordination and bring in experts where needed; company knowledge becomes “organisational intelligence”.
- Leadership has to make room for mistakes and shared learning – and treat AI as a chance to rethink, as is already happening in the US and China.



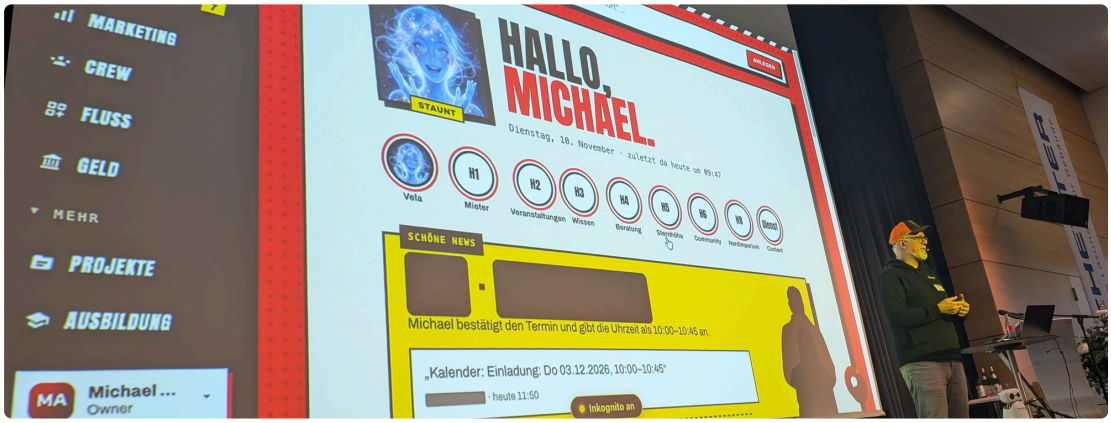
Talk in progress during the keynote (appliedAI / State of AI)

13:45–14:15

Keynote 2: From AI hype to everyday work: how people and companies start taking action

Michael Aechtler, Managing Director, Gamechangerz UG

- Aechtler says that with Gamechangerz he supports 50 to 70 companies in introducing AI – and finds that it is usually people, not systems, who need help taking the first step.
- He dismantled three myths: AI takes over tasks, not jobs; hallucinations mostly come from badly built systems; and “we're not allowed to” (for example because of data protection) should no longer be an excuse – solutions exist.
- Live on stage he showed VELA, the system behind Gamechangerz as a “zero-person company”: every company goal gets its own agent with access to a locally hosted company memory and a toolbox.
- Good results come from training: let it produce, give feedback, repeat. His writing style was learned from ten years of LinkedIn posts and twelve years of emails; he still approves every outgoing email himself.
- A first campaign of just 50 targeted emails led to 26 meetings – so many that he now deliberately moves more slowly and with more focus.
- His advice: start with one concrete case, project or department instead of debating for months – and think bigger.



Live demo of an AI agent on the screen

14:15–14:55

Keynote 3: From data to performance: how companies reach higher performance with AI

Hanna Huber, Senior Leader Group Global IT | Digital Strategy & Culture, Drees & Sommer SE

- Huber heads Digital Strategy & Culture at Drees & Sommer and is responsible for the company-wide digital transformation of the roughly 7,000-strong firm.
- Her thesis: two thirds of transformation happens at the organisational level – roles, skills, processes and leadership. A report written quickly with AI is worthless if the meeting to discuss it only happens weeks later.
- Drees & Sommer mirrors its digital organisation into every business unit, with dedicated digital partners and short decision paths through digital boards up to executive-board level.
- Skills are built in four learning fields – AI, data, cybersecurity and soft skills – plus learning in the flow of work and a digital mentoring programme.
- What matters is impact, not time saved: companies need to decide what freed-up hours are used for – for example new business models.
- Her closing thought: “Alles bleibt anders” (everything stays different) – and what remains constant is people. In the discussion she added that employees tend to find adoption too slow, while security questions sometimes force the company to brake.

Slide “Alles bleibt anders” (everything stays different) during Hanna Huber’s keynote

Forum 1

Planning, data and digital project delivery

15:30–15:50

From data to decisions: BIM, automation and AI as accelerators

Patrizia Bengel, ATP architekten ingenieure

- Bengel is responsible for strategy and development of the building-services division at ATP. Her starting point: specialists spend a large share of their working time on low-value tasks such as searching for project information.
- Automation, structured data, BIM and AI are meant to reduce routine work so that more time remains for professional judgement.
- In design, ATP uses optimisation tools, for example to find the best view quality for a building or the maximum number of parking spaces in an underground car park.
- Her principle: the system searches for the optimum, the human defines what optimal means – and remains responsible for the decision.

15:50–16:10

The data foundation for orchestration – how structured component and zone data make AI-driven procurement and delivery on site possible

Sven Assmann, Adolf Würth GmbH & Co. KG; **Matthäus Grzondziel**, Adolf Würth GmbH & Co. KG

- Matthäus Grzondziel of Würth showed why AI “starves” between design and job site: orchestrating procurement and delivery rarely fails because of the logic, but because of missing, end-to-end data.
- Components need a clear spatial assignment to project zones and a link to the schedule and SAP processes – only then do location and time become reliable information.
- His principle is zero error tolerance in the data foundation: 100% process reliability on site requires 100% data integrity.
- Once the data foundation is in place, just-in-time delivery based on actual construction progress becomes possible, and operators receive a complete as-built dataset instead of binders.
- The benefits show up in tied-up capital, CO_2 reporting and liability: the data trail works like a flight recorder for the building.

16:10–16:30

Construction projects that think ahead

Maria Tsagkalidi, alago

> The recording does not mention the speaker's name or company, but timing and topic clearly match this programme slot.

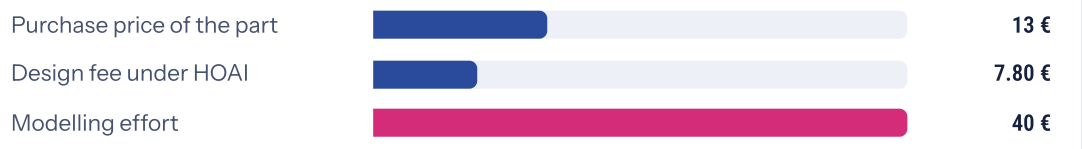
- In conversations with more than 300 project managers, the team did not find a single working task-management setup: tasks arise in meetings, emails, phone calls and chats and end up in six different systems.
- Every role – site management, design, project control – makes its own system the “single source of truth”. When one person completes a task, it stays open elsewhere until someone passes the word on.
- Central task management doesn't solve this. The proposal: everyone stays in their own system and an AI agent keeps the systems in sync – using “computer use” for platforms without an interface.
- If schedule and meeting minutes use the same terms, the agent can measure progress per work package and build a project memory that carries lessons learned into future projects.
- Recommendation: start with your own tasks, connect systems instead of replacing them – and don't measure progress by ticked-off tasks.

16:30–16:50

When the BIM model costs more than the installation: how AI rescues engineering design

Armin Jäger, EFG Engineering Facility Group

- Jäger, managing director of a building-services engineering firm, did the maths: a ball valve with 122 attributes in the BIM model costs about €13 to buy and earns roughly €7.80 in HOAI fees – but takes around €40 of modelling effort.
- All employees use Copilot; a central expert group builds dedicated agents in Copilot Studio – from a “use-case coach” to an agent architect and a skills toolkit.
- What works well: plan comparisons (for example fire dampers in the floor plan versus the schematic), quantity take-offs, area lists from poor PDFs and plausibility checks of tender documents against the drawings.
- Not yet reliable: generating drawings or Revit constructions. And office standards erode when Excel templates are simply uploaded to the AI.
- His advice: use AI where tasks recur often, the data is good and the risk of error is manageable – and pay for two days of external AI expertise rather than experimenting alone.



One ball valve with 122 attributes in the BIM model: modelling costs more than the part and the fee combined.

16:50–17:10

From the hybrid engineering office to agentic work – how five AI agents are changing everyday planning

Christopher Duftschmid, IDZ – Ingenieure der Zukunft

- Duftschmid showed how his Munich design office with around 20 employees works in a hybrid way: five AI agents take on clearly defined day-to-day tasks.
- Agent “Alex” writes explanatory reports in the office's style from a growing knowledge base; another agent researches standards and always cites its sources; a third checks contracts and tender documents.
- The assistant “Donna” knows the calendar, inbox and minutes templates and prepares meetings; a “Challenger” reviews everything that goes to the client from the client's perspective. A human always gives the final approval.
- Agents have a self-description with role, goals and office standards – and need leadership like a junior employee. Time gained should go into quality, not just more revenue.
- For roll-out he recommended a mixed core team – from the sceptic to the colleague about to retire – a pilot and then the roll-out. It took no computer scientists and no million-euro budget, but AI skills across the whole team.

17:10–17:30

Data sovereignty instead of a black box: AI in tendering

Liza Ocklenburg, Cosuno Ventures GmbH

- Ocklenburg presented Cosuno, a Berlin-based tendering and procurement platform founded in 2019 that today supports almost 700 partners in sending out requests and collecting bids.
- In work stages 6 and 7, AI can create a structured, GAEB-exportable bill of quantities from drawings and specifications, and check bids for potential change orders and plausibility.
- She described three black boxes – the third being your own data on external platforms. At Cosuno every step is documented, and uploaded data is visible only to your own team.
- Two questions for any solution: can I see what the AI does and approve it? And can I take my bidder and price data with me at any time?

17:30–17:50

Building cheaper, faster, better and with fewer resources: how the AI-based OPTIMUSE platform gets more return out of every project

Nomi Aghasi, OPTIMUSE GmbH

> This talk is not included in the recording. At the start of the following talk a short-notice cancellation was mentioned, and Dr Petraus used the freed-up time for a longer talk.

How does one take energy and building-services decisions early, quickly and reliably, before they become expensive? AI-supported energy simulation on the basis of BIM/IFC speeds up TGA planning, supports compliance with national energy rules, and makes value engineering data-based. Example: for a general contractor we assessed a new building of around 200,000 m² GFA in the tender. After four weeks the energy class was available, instead of conventionally more than four months. Clients compare variants while changes are still cheap, planners save variant calculations, bidders an expensive certification. Operators reduce operating costs and have an ESG/EPBD basis.

17:50–18:10

Deciding before the data exists: AI in the early planning phase

Dr.-Ing. Bernd Petraus, TMM Group

- Petraus first explained what language models can and cannot do: they are black boxes, don't learn from individual conversations and only work with what fits into their context window – which is why humans must keep checking.
- Generating a BIM model or code with AI is fast; changing it in a targeted way later is laborious. Geometry is not a language, and complete models quickly exceed any context window.
- AI is especially valuable in early design because it copes with incomplete, contradictory data – teams should stay abstract for a long time and only model in detail after the key decisions.
- Instead of one big AI application, he expects many small tools following the “one tool, one task” principle; work stages will shift towards more functional tendering.
- As a practical example he showed a digital energy concept for an industrial site – from load profiles and land use to a comparison of variants, where grid connection and storage end up as the central questions.

Forum 2

Execution, building services and intelligent operations

15:30–15:50

From BIM model to automated job site – how digital planning enables productivity, prefabrication and robotics

Axel Mühlenbruch, Hilti Deutschland AG

- Mühlenbruch, Hilti's technical lead for engineering and robotics, showed the path from digital model to automated job site using the Jaibot ceiling-drilling robot.
- The robot doesn't drill "by itself": it needs exact positions and drilling points. A typical building-services model is too coarse for this – what's needed is an end-to-end data chain from anchor planning to the machine.
- On site, the system provides transparency, for example how many holes were drilled in the last few minutes and which could not be set because of collisions.
- There is often less AI involved than in the keynotes, but concrete automation that raises productivity and counters the skills shortage.

15:50–16:10

AI in the fan: detect conditions, prevent failures, secure operations

André Müller, ZIEHL-ABEGG SE

- Ziehl-Abegg has annual revenue of around one billion euros, about 90% of it from fans for ventilation and air-conditioning systems, heat pumps and residential ventilation.
- Modern EC fans have a vibration sensor directly on the circuit board. This allows bearing condition and imbalance to be monitored continuously instead of sending technicians to hundreds of units.
- Because temperature, installation and age all affect vibration values, Ziehl-Abegg uses a neural network on its own servers to distinguish normal operation from developing damage.
- This turns rigid maintenance intervals into predictive maintenance: a bearing is neither replaced too early nor fails unexpectedly after a fraction of its expected service life.

16:10–16:30

From sensor to decision: how high-quality room and energy data enable intelligent buildings

Philipp Becker, BELIMO; **Alexander Saumer**, BELIMO

> In the recording, Alexander Saumer presents.

- Alexander Saumer of Belimo (“we make the orange actuators”) used a meeting room to show how good data leads to better decisions in building operation.
- Precise room sensors for temperature, CO_2 and humidity must be accurate under real installation conditions – a CO_2 sensor, for example, gives off heat itself, which can distort the reading.
- The Belimo Energy Valve measures the power actually delivered and optimises operation via the ΔT manager; in its MID-certified version, the values can even be used for billing.
- Combined room and energy data reveal what a warehouse, production hall or individual building wing consumes – the basis for later AI analyses.

16:30–16:50

AI in ventilation technology: practical experience at TROX

Dorothea Völkerling, TROX SE

- Völkerling has worked in TROX's IT AI team for around five years and reported how the ventilation manufacturer already uses AI today – in processes and in products.
- Internally, TROX runs its own open-source-based chatbot that knows the website and intranet, as well as AI-supported order capture that extracts orders from emails and attachments.
- Feedback and quality monitoring are essential – otherwise nobody notices when a chatbot talks nonsense.
- In research and production, machine learning is being tested to detect anomalies and faults in air-handling units early from vibration and operating data.

16:50–17:10

Creating energy flexibility: how the modular refurbishment of a care home combines efficiency, security of supply and decarbonisation

Johannes Rauh, Bosch Energy and Building Solutions GmbH

> Because of illness, the talk was given by a Bosch colleague, a project lead for energy efficiency, standing in for Johannes Rauh.

- Electrification is changing existing buildings: heat pumps, electric process heat, storage, flexible tariffs and the grid connection all have to be considered together.
- Bosch takes a step-by-step approach: first a potential analysis and concept (eligible for up to 60% funding), then implementation in stages through to plant operation.
- In the case of a care facility with two gas boilers, air-to-water heat pumps cover around 65% of the heat demand in the first step; gas is kept only for peak loads. The goal is a supply based entirely on renewable energy.
- Central energy monitoring for gas and electricity and control via Logamatic 5000 create the data basis to run the heat pump when electricity prices are low, for example.

17:10–17:30

From energy data to measurable savings: the Brugger Magnetsysteme case

Miriam Helbig, Mondas GmbH

- Helbig presented Mondas, an energy-data platform from Freiburg, spun off from Fraunhofer ISE in 2018 and now around 30 people strong.
- At Brugger Magnetsysteme, energy data from production, building services and photovoltaics are brought together centrally. The starting point was the wish for transparency about machine consumption – AI comes later.
- The measurements show what measures achieve: the switch to LED cut lighting electricity consumption by around 50%.
- A “peak-load traffic light” warns when grid draw exceeds the self-imposed limit of 160 kW (the transformer is rated for 250 kW, and 207 kW has already been measured) – the basis for battery storage and machine control.

Self-imposed limit	Measured peak	Transformer rating
160 kW	**207 kW**	**250 kW**
	▲ above the limit	

The “peak-load traffic light” at Brugger Magnetsysteme flags when grid draw exceeds the limit.

17:30–17:50

Secure and redundant automation with the QronoX controller

Jürgen Ferstl, SBC Deutschland GmbH

- Ferstl, head of sales South at SBC (Saia Burgess Controls), used real cases to show why cybersecurity is a must in building automation – such as hacked refrigerated counters that suddenly heated instead of cooled.
- The more open and connected systems are, the larger the attack surface. What's needed is a controller that repels attacks, is fail-safe and always operates consistently.
- In the case of a new high-tech production facility in Berlin, the Saia PCD QronoX controller is used with security level 3 according to IEC 62443 and a redundant control architecture, connected via BACnet.
- His conclusion: cybersecurity has to be designed into a new building right down to the controller level from the planning stage.

17:50–18:10

Human-centric autonomous buildings: with AI from reactive to predictive building operation

Simon Pfau, Siemens AG – Smart Infrastructure

- Pfau presented Siemens' vision of the human-centric, autonomous building – which is already partly reality. Many “smart” buildings today are still a patchwork of individual solutions.
- Generation, storage and consumption are scheduled 24 hours ahead and then adjusted live; on average this cuts total energy costs by around 15% and noticeably raises self-consumption.
- An “energy twin” simulates scenarios in under 30 minutes instead of one to two weeks as before; in engineering, around 25% of the effort could be saved.
- AI detects deviations early and prioritises measures; humans set the guardrails and decide. The prerequisites are connected systems and a data strategy from the planning stage onwards.

Photos from the day

Stage with the welcome slide “herzlich willkommen”, Bürgerhaus Kernen

Speaker on stage in front of the slide “Zukunft! Wir sind bereit”

Reachy robot on a stand in the hall

Live demo of an AI agent on the screen

Hanna Huber on stage

Slide “Alles bleibt anders” (everything stays different) during Hanna Huber’s keynote

How this recap was made

The summaries are based on live recordings that the Reachy Mini robot transcribed automatically during the talks. Because speech recognition is not always reliable with names and technical terms, the content was checked against the public programme. Where the match to a talk is uncertain, this is marked. No verbatim quotes are given.

More at industrietag-rm.de, schetter.de and gamechangerz.io